

Write About a Time...

DIFFICULT PRACTICE

Name _____

Date set _____

Due _____

40–50 min

SUGGESTED TIME

1st person

REQUIRED VOICE

**Real or
invented**

CAN BE EITHER

YOUR PROMPT

Write about a time you were certain you were right — and were not.

This can be a real memory or a fully invented one — either is fine. What matters is that it reads as true: specific, sensory, and honest about how it actually felt to be wrong, not just a neat moral at the end.

TECHNIQUE REQUIRED**HONESTY OF VOICE**

Show the moment of certainty **before** the reader knows it's wrong — don't foreshadow it too early.

At least one moment of genuine embarrassment, frustration, or discomfort shown through action or thought, not just stated ("I felt embarrassed").

Avoid a tidy "and that's when I learned..." closing line — real realisations are usually messier than that.

STRUCTURE

Use a flashback or time-shift at least once, signalled clearly (not confusingly) to the reader.

Present the moment of being proven wrong as a specific scene, with dialogue or concrete detail — not a summary.

LANGUAGE

At least 3 precise sensory details (specific, not generic — "the smell of the school photocopier," not "it smelled bad").

One rhetorical question used naturally, to show the narrator questioning themselves.

CONTROL

Vary sentence length deliberately around the moment of realisation — a short sentence can land harder than a long one here.

Correct use of past perfect ("had done") where you're describing something that happened before the main timeline of the story.

YOUR WRITING

CHECKLIST — GO OVER IT AGAIN

1. **Does it feel true, even if it's invented?** Vague or generic details are the biggest giveaway of a rushed answer.
2. Check every use of "I" is followed by a verb that fits — no dangling or fragmented sentences unless deliberate.
3. Past perfect ("had") used correctly for anything that happened before the main scene.
4. No summarising sentence that explains the "lesson" too neatly — let the reader feel it instead.
5. Read the ending aloud — does it stop at the right moment, or does it keep going past where it should?
6. Check for repeated words across nearby sentences and swap for a synonym.